# The world in brief

Catch up quickly on the global stories that matter

Photograph: AP

Buckingham Palace said a state visit by **King Charles** and Queen Camilla to America will go ahead on Monday, despite security worries after a shooting at the White House Correspondents' Association dinner on Saturday. In an interview Donald Trump claimed the gunman, who was arrested, had "a manifesto" and "hates Christians". Everyone at the dinner was safely evacuated.

Mr Trump said in an interview that if **Iran's** leaders wanted to make a deal they only had to call. On Sunday Abbas Araghchi, Iran's foreign minister, returned to Islamabad for the second time in several days to continue talks with the Pakistani government, which is trying to mediate. On Saturday Mr Trump cancelled the trip of Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, two of his envoys, to Pakistan.

Sabastian Sawe became the first person to run a **sub-two-hour marathon** in race conditions. The 31-year-old Kenyan completed the London marathon in one hour, 59 minutes and 30 seconds. Yomif Kejelcha, an Ethiopian who came second, also finished in under two hours. In 2019 Eliud Kipchoge, another Kenyan, achieved the same feat, but because he used a team of pacemakers the record was not official.

Thom Tillis, a Republican member of the Senate banking committee, said he would support **Kevin Warsh's** appointment as chair of the **Federal Reserve**. Mr Tillis had threatened to block Mr Warsh's nomination while the Department of Justice continued its spurious investigation into Jerome Powell, the outgoing chair. Mr Tillis saw it as a threat to the central bank's independence. The DoJ abandoned its probe on Friday.

**China** issued its first set of rules for companies employing gig workers such as delivery riders. Regulation for the **gig economy** was previously piecemeal, meaning workers were easily exploited. By 2027 the government aims to have policies in place that include standardised labour protections and pay. Officials will now also have more oversight of the algorithms and systems used by e-commerce giants like Alibaba and JD.com.

**Viktor Orban**, the former prime minister of Hungary, said he would not take his seat in parliament when it reconvenes on May 9th. Mr Orban's Fidesz party suffered a crushing defeat at the hands of the country's new leader, Peter Magyar, and his Tisza party earlier this month. "I am now needed not in parliament, but in the reorganisation of the patriotic movement," he said in a Facebook video.

**Russia** fired 47 missiles and more than 600 drones at **Ukraine** overnight. Ukraine said it had intercepted most of these, though at least seven people were killed, including five in the city of Dnipro. "Most targets are civilian infrastructure in cities," noted the Ukrainian president, Volodymyr Zelensky, on social media. Meanwhile a Ukrainian drone hit an apartment building in the city of Yekaterinburg, nearly 1,600km from the border.

**Figure of the day:** *$150,000*, the auction price of a four-foot tall Labubu doll, a toy at the centre of a strange speculative bubble. Read the full story.

Photograph: eyevine

## Elon Musk and Sam Altman battle in court

A trial worthy of Hollywood is about to begin in California. The world's richest man, Elon Musk, will face off against Sam Altman, boss of the world's most famous AI company. Mr Musk helped set up OpenAI, the firm behind ChatGPT, as a non-profit venture in 2015, but departed in 2018. He argues that Mr Altman (and others) went against that founding principle by shifting to a profit-driven structure. He wants OpenAI and Microsoft, one of its backers, to pay more than $134bn in damages—to go to OpenAI's charitable arm, he says—and remove Mr Altman and Greg Brockman, another co-founder. OpenAI claims this is a baseless attempt by a weaker rival (Mr Musk owns xAI as part of SpaceX, his rocket company) to undermine the industry front-runner.

Both billionaires are expected to testify. A verdict may take weeks. Betting markets don't much fancy Mr Musk's chances. The jury, selected on Monday, can expect some drama with their duty.

Photograph: U.S. Central Command

## Stasis in the Strait

Bahrain, currently president of the UN Security Council, will chair a meeting on maritime security on Monday. The issue is crucial for both the kingdom and its neighbours in the Gulf, but the meeting will only highlight their powerlessness. The Strait of Hormuz is still blockaded by both America and Iran. On average four ships make it through each day (down from around 125 normally). Gulf states want allies to send warships as escorts. That looks unlikely before the war ends.

And a conclusion does not seem imminent. Abbas Araghchi, the Iranian foreign minister, has spent recent days in Pakistan, which has been trying to mediate a deal, but has refused to meet the Americans. The American delegation hasn't turned up at all—the country's diplomats say that they remain unsatisfied with Mr Araghchi's latest proposal for ending the war. The coming days may bring a fresh round of talks. Until then, the standoff continues.

Photograph: Getty Images

## An awkward royal visit

The ideal time for a state visit is not shortly after a possible assassination attempt on the host. But even before a gunman stormed the White House correspondents' dinner on Saturday, King Charles III's trip to America, which begins on Monday, had diplomats on edge. The visit, ostensibly for the 250th anniversary of American independence, has become a mission to save the "special relationship".

Donald Trump resents British objections to his foreign forays, particularly in Iran. Meanwhile, Sir Keir Starmer, Britain's prime minister, is "fed up" with the economic impact of the president's actions. And polling suggests the American and British publics are souring on each other's countries, too. Mr Trump is a fan of Britain's royal family: he described his stay at Windsor Castle with King Charles in September as "one of the highest honours" of his life. But pomp and pageantry can go only so far in healing a rift.

Photograph: Getty Images

## South Africa’s precarious progress

Monday is “Freedom Day”, when South Africans celebrate the anniversary of the first elections in which all races could vote in 1994. Much has improved in the 32 years since. The country now has a basic welfare state and a larger black middle class. More South Africans socialise across racial lines; two-thirds say they would support the best person for president, regardless of race. The economy—moribund for at least a decade—has recently shown signs of life, partly because of belated reforms to state-owned enterprises such as Eskom, the utility company.

But war in the Gulf has slowed that momentum; South Africa’s reliance on imported fuel makes it vulnerable to rising prices. Though somewhat tempered by a coalition government since 2024, the ruling African National Congress party is still plagued by corruption and incompetence. On April 23rd the president suspended the head of police, the latest powerful figure embroiled in alleged graft. South Africa has come far; it has much further to go.

Illustration: Sandra Navarro

# Daily quiz

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [email protected]. We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

**Monday:** Which character is the main archenemy of the Fantastic Four, in both the comic book and film series?

*The beginning is always today.*

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***Mary Wollstonecraft***